



UNDERGROUND VEGETABLES



Some plants are not grown for their leafy tops, but for the parts of them that grow beneath the soil.

Carrots, turnips, radishes, and parsnips are the fat roots of plants, and are known as root vegetables. Potatoes are the swollen part of the underground stem of the plant. They are called tubers. Onions, too, grow in the dark earth, but it is the bulb of these plants that we eat.



The flowers produce seeds that can be used to grow new plants, but it is more usual to use seed potatoes.



Farming with nature

Many farmers use chemical fertilizers and pesticides to help them grow crops efficiently, but some farmers use only natural products. They use fertilizers such as manure, and encourage pest controllers like ladybugs, which eat all sorts of flies and larvae. This helps to stop a buildup of chemicals in the environment and is called organic farming.

Potato plants grow well in cool climates, but are killed by frost.



Radish



Carrot



Beet



These are the tubers. Each plant has between 15 and 20 tubers.